

Thomas Gates III

Forward Deployed Engineer — AI Systems & Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Forward Deployed Engineer with 4+ years embedded inside enterprise security and cloud infrastructure, now shipping production AI systems — translating ambiguous business problems into deployed software end-to-end, no hand-off.
- Full-stack builder of production LLM and multi-agent systems (Claude API, n8n, Next.js/TypeScript) spanning automated lead qualification, six-agent e-commerce orchestration, and AI-assisted IAM policy generation.
- Proven inside real, messy enterprise environments: hardened cloud infrastructure across AWS and Azure, drove a 30% reduction in critical vulnerabilities, and automated IAM workflows across 40+ production systems. AWS Certified | CISA | NIST, ISO 27001, SOC 2.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Agent Engineering: Claude API (Anthropic SDK), LLM Integration & Prompt Engineering, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Agentic Workflow Automation (n8n), Production Rate-Limiting & Fallback Design

Full-Stack & Deployment: TypeScript, React, Next.js (App Router), Python, REST APIs, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Vercel, Upstash Redis

Cloud & Infrastructure Security: AWS (Security Hub, GuardDuty, Inspector, IAM, KMS), Azure, GCP, CSPM, Secure Configuration

Identity, Risk & Compliance: IAM/PAM/MFA/Least Privilege, Vulnerability Management (Tenable, Qualys, Nessus), Splunk SIEM, Incident Response, NIST, ISO 27001, SOC 2

Automation & Systems: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Windows, Linux, VMware, Hyper-V

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, CISA, OCI Foundations Associate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Universal Technical Services — *Security Engineer / IT Compliance Auditor* | January 2021 – February 2026

- Embedded directly with infrastructure and compliance stakeholders to identify, prioritize, and remediate vulnerabilities across cloud and on-prem systems, running continuous scanning and patching to hold security baselines.
- Owned cloud security posture across AWS and Azure end-to-end — deployed CSPM tooling to continuously monitor misconfigurations, driving a 30% reduction in critical vulnerabilities.
- Redesigned IAM practices (least privilege, MFA enforcement, access reviews) across 40+ enterprise systems, working directly with system owners to close excessive-access gaps without disrupting operations.
- Built and shipped Python, PowerShell, and Bash automation for patch management, hardening, and access provisioning, cutting manual operational effort by 35%.
- Translated technical risk into business terms for leadership, documenting controls against NIST, ISO 27001, and SOC 2 and briefing stakeholders on remediation status.

Spectrum — *Technical Support Engineer* | March 2023 – May 2024

- Administered Windows and Linux systems for 500+ end users, standing up secure configuration baselines and SLA-driven patch management in a live production environment.
- Stood up logging and monitoring integrated with SIEM platforms, enabling faster incident detection, investigation, and response for critical systems.
- Automated recurring support workflows with PowerShell and Bash, contributing to an 89% first-call resolution rate.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

FDE Portfolio — *Live AI Product Suite* | *Next.js 14, TypeScript, Claude API, Upstash Redis, Resend, Vercel*

- Designed, built, and shipped a production web application hosting five live AI tools end-to-end, including an AI Agent Designer that generates deployable system prompts and exports Claude Code skills and n8n workflow files.
- Engineered a shared rate-limiting and graceful-fallback layer so every AI feature degrades safely under load instead of failing — a production-reliability pattern, not a demo shortcut.

Speed to Lead — *AI Lead Qualification Pipeline* | *n8n, Twilio, SendGrid, Claude API, Next.js*

- Built an automation pipeline that qualifies inbound leads in real time and auto-drafts on-brand follow-ups by email and SMS, surfacing the AI's reasoning alongside every verdict.

Optimistic OS — *Multi-Agent Automation Pipeline* | *Claude, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Etsy & Pinterest APIs*

- Architected a six-agent pipeline (trend research, image generation, listing creation, marketing scheduling) that takes a product from idea to a live, marketed listing with no manual intervention.

AI-Powered IAM Policy Generator | *Python, AWS IAM, Least-Privilege Automation*

- Built an AI-driven least-privilege policy generator that automated access reviews and remediation workflows, reducing IAM over-provisioning risk by 90%.

EDUCATION

East Carolina University — Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | 2020